

2008 Hun Sen's CPP wins a general election amid fraud allegations.

2010 The former Khmer Rouge prison commandant Duch is found guilty of crimes against humanity and sentenced to 35 years imprisonment.

«172–73 Lost Empires

«412–13 End of the Colonial Era

Vietnam



Partitioned in 1954, Vietnam was unified in 1976 after military victory by the communist North.

939 CE After 1,000 years of Chinese domination, a semi-independent Vietnamese state is created around the Red River delta by Ngo Quyen.

1516 A group of Portuguese adventurers are first Europeans to reach Vietnam.

1862 Southern Vietnam (Cochin China) becomes a French colony, followed by central and northern Vietnam (Annam and Tonkin) in 1883.

1920 Quoc ngu (Roman script) replaces Chinese script.

1930 Ho Chi Minh founds the Indochina Communist Party.

1940 Japanese invasion.

1941 Viet Minh resistance founded in exile in China.

1945 Viet Minh take Saigon and Hanoi. Emperor abdicates. Democratic Republic of Vietnam proclaimed.

1946 First Indochina War with France.

1954 French are defeated at Dien Bien Phu. Vietnam is divided at 17°N. USSR supports the North, while the US arms the South.

1960 Groups opposed to the Dien Bien Phu regime in South Vietnam unite as the Viet Cong.

1961 US pours in military advisers. US Congress approves war in 1964.

1965 General Nguyen Van Thieu takes over military government of South. First US combat troops arrive.

1965–68 Operation Rolling Thunder—intense bombing of the North by US.

1967 Antiwar protests start in US.

1968 In the Tet (New Year) Offensive, 105 towns are attacked in South with infiltrated arms. Viet Cong suffers serious losses. Peace talks begin.

1969 Ho Chi Minh dies, succeeded by Le Duan. War intensifies in spite of continuing peace talks.

1970 US begins secret attacks in Laos and Cambodia and new mass bombing of North to keep arms from reaching Viet Cong.

1972 Eleven-day Christmas Campaign is heaviest US bombing of war.

1973 Paris Peace Agreements signed, but fighting continues.

1975 Fall of Saigon to combined forces of North and Provisional Revolutionary (Viet Cong) Government of South.

1976 Vietnam united as the Socialist Republic of Vietnam. Saigon renamed Ho Chi Minh City.

1978 Invasion of Cambodia to oust Pol Pot regime (by January 1979).

1979 Nine-Day War with China. “Boat people” crisis. At a UN conference, Vietnam agrees to allow legal emigration.

1986 Death of Le Duan. Nguyen Van Linh initiates liberal economic policy of *doi moi* (renovation).

1992 Revised constitution allows foreign investment, but essential role of Communist Party is unchanged.

1995 US–Vietnamese relations normalized. Vietnam joins ASEAN.

2000 Bill Clinton becomes the first US president to visit Vietnam since the war.

2007 Joins World Trade Organization.

2007 President Nguyen Minh Triet is the first Vietnamese head of state to visit US since the end of the Vietnam War in 1975.

2008 Vietnam and China sign an agreement to end their long-running border dispute.

«172–73 Lost Empires

«350–51 Colonial Resistance

«412–13 End of the Colonial Era

«430–31 The Vietnam War

Malaysia



The Federation of Malaysia comprises Peninsular Malaysia, Sarawak, and Sabah.

1400s Conversion of Malay peoples to Islam begins.

1826 British settlements of Malacca, Penang, and Singapore joined together as Straits Settlements colony.

1957 Malaya gains independence.

1963 Federation of Malaysia founded.

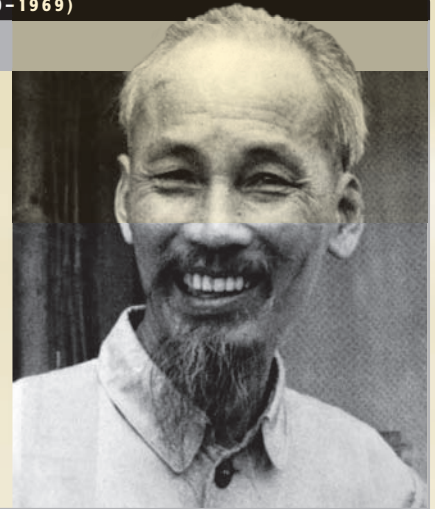
1965 Singapore leaves federation, reducing Malaysian states to 13.

1970 Malay-Chinese ethnic tension forces resignation of prime minister

VIETNAMESE REVOLUTIONARY (1890–1969)

HO CHI MINH

Ho Chi Minh founded the Indochina Communist Party in 1930. During World War II he led the Viet Minh guerrillas and established a government in Hanoi in 1945. When the French tried to regain control he proclaimed independence and led the resistance that forced the French to withdraw. President of North Vietnam from 1955, he successfully countered US involvement in Vietnam in the 1960s, by which time he was in failing health. “Uncle Ho” came to symbolize the communists’ willingness to endure a war of attrition. He died six years before the US finally withdrew from South Vietnam.



Tunku Abdul Rahman. New prime minister, Tun Abdul Razak, creates the National Front (BN) coalition.

1976–78 Guerrilla attacks by banned Communist Party of Malaya (CPM), based in southern Thailand.

1976 Tun Abdul Razak dies and is succeeded by his deputy.

1977 Unrest in Kelantan following expulsion of its chief minister from the Pan-Malaysian Islamic Party (PAS).

1978 Elections consolidate BN power. Government rejects Chinese university.

1978–89 Unrestricted asylum given to Vietnamese refugees.

1981 Mahathir Muhammad becomes prime minister.

1987 Detention without trial of 106 politicians from all parties suspected of Chinese sympathies. Media censored.

1989 Disaffected members of ruling UMNO party join opposition PAS. CPM signs peace agreement with Malaysian and Thai governments.

1997 Major financial crisis.

1998 Prime Minister Mahathir Muhammad fires his deputy and presumed successor, Anwar Ibrahim, on charges of sexual misconduct.

2001 Ethnic clashes between Malays and ethnic Indians.

2005 A crackdown on illegal immigration sees an exodus of hundreds of thousands of illegal workers.

2006 Construction of a bridge linking Malaysia to Singapore is shelved.

2008 The ruling National Front loses its two-thirds majority in parliament, its worst election result in decades.

«172–73 Lost Empires

«282–83 Exploring the Pacific

«412–13 End of the Colonial Era

Singapore



A former British colony with an authoritarian government and strict social controls.

1819 Sir Stamford Raffles, a British East India Company official, establishes a trading station on Singapore island.

1824 The Malays cede the whole island to the East India Company in perpetuity.

1869 Suez Canal opens and trade with Europe booms.

1941 Singapore falls to the Japanese.

1946 Singapore becomes separate colony under UK rule.

1954 The People's Action Party (PAP) is formed under Lee Kuan Yew.

1959 Self-government is won. Lee Kuan Yew becomes first prime minister.

1963 Joins the Federation of Malaysia.

1965 Singapore declares itself an independent republic.

1984 Opposition candidates win two seats in general election: first non-PAP MPs since 1966.

1990 Lee Kuan Yew steps down after 31 years. Goh Chok Tong becomes new prime minister.

1993 Ong Teng Cheong first directly elected president.

1995 Briton Nick Leeson is sentenced to six years in prison for his disastrous dealing on the Singapore stock exchange.

2004 Lee Hsien Loong, eldest son of Lee Kuan Yew, becomes prime minister.

2006 President Lee Hsien Loong wins general election for the PAP.

«172–73 Lost Empires

«350–51 Colonial Resistance